



See my portfolio

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Mikkel Køster

Design Leader / Product Strategist / UX Designer

About me

With +13 years of experience in the digital space as a hybrid product strategist and UX designer and 6 years in design leadership, I am extremely proficient in solving complex business problems. I have a strategic mindset mixed with a strong UX/UI craft and proven leadership skills. More than anything I am a creative thinker who translates insights and concepts into best-in-class digital products and services.

Short resumé

I currently lead the design efforts at [Formalize](#), a reg-tech company, where I oversee the platform's overall design direction, creating customizable compliance solutions. Before this, I led a team of 8 designers at [Maersk](#) on an end-to-end supply chain platform. I also designed an e-commerce site from scratch for a brand-new concept around selling sleep — [Sleepacy](#). Prior to that, I worked as Experience Design Director at the renowned strategic design company [1508](#). Following my dream, I moved to NYC where I worked at an innovation agency called [Firstborn](#).

Additionally, I have worked for 4 years at [NoA Ignite](#) as a hybrid strategist and UX'er. I've further worked at [Monstarlab](#) (formerly Nodes) as a digital advisor, dipped my toes in the start-up world by selling prescriptive glasses with Riot Bernard, and interned at the world-acclaimed branding agency [Wolff Olins](#) in London. Finally, I am a graduate of [The Kaospilots](#) — a hybrid business and design school.

Sep 2024 – Now

www.formalize.com

Formalize helps companies stay ahead in the ever-evolving compliance landscape by offering a customizable compliance platform that streamlines governance, risk, and compliance (GRC) processes.

Formalize

Head of Product Design

Tasks

- Oversee the overall experience and design direction of the platform.
- Collaborate closely with tech teams and the CTO to align on solving key design challenges.
- Work hands-on with the team to deliver impactful design solutions.

Achievements

- Transformed the design process by replacing freelance contributors with in-house designers, hiring a Senior Product Designer and a Student Designer within three months.
- Designed and implemented a new design system with reusable components, enabling a more modern and efficient development process.
- Improved user experience and streamlined workflows to enhance both design quality and delivery speed.

Jan 2021 – Sep 2024

3 years 3 months

www.maersk.com

Maersk's Supply Chain Platform is an integrated end-to-end supply chain platform that handles complicated logistics processes - allowing customers more time to concentrate on their core business. The vision is to become the global integrator of container logistics.

Maersk

Lead UX Designer

Tasks

- I led and guided a team of 8 senior UXers and craft the experience vision for a pivotal end-to-end supply chain platform. It engages 350+ people across 20+ product teams and 260 engineers.
- I played a vital role in directing the user experience for both internal and external users, elevating the design IQ of the entire team, and advocating for the significance of UX throughout the organization.

Achievements

- Expanded a design team from 6 to 12 designers in just 6 months, implementing a new, effective design organizational structure featuring three sub-teams: Product Design, Design System, and Research.
- Championed a change in UXD work processes, ensuring earlier involvement and elevated the standards for design excellence, establishing a consistent and cohesive design approach.
- Initiated a new design system project called "Flea Market" to bolster Maersk's existing framework, simplifying intricate platform interactions and expediting the creation of new experiences

Jan 2021 – Jul 2021

6 months

www.sleepacy.se

Hilding Anders Group is one of the world's leading bed and mattress producers and has embarked on a global, digital transformation, accelerating its mission to "Improve Life Through Sleep" through the brand Sleepacy

Sleepacy

Head of UX

Tasks

- I led the digital experience by helping transform the business from a leading bedding and mattress supplier to a consumer centric, digital-first health and wellness company.
- My role covers the entire product lifecycle, working collaboratively in a multidisciplinary team, to translate unmet consumer needs into compelling consumer journeys and digital solutions

Achievements

- Responsible for conceptualizing and designing an engaging e-commerce site from scratch
- Driving a brand new concept for an app that offers "Sleep Services" from concepts and prototypes at multiple levels to user validations to a final design
- Leading external design and development agencies to align on vision for building the digital offerings.

Oct 2018 – Jan 2021

2 years 4 months

www.1508.dk

1508 helps companies build valuable services, experiences or processes to accelerate their digital transformation and innovation. 1508 designs what matters.

1508

• Experience Design Director, Jun 2019 – Jan 2021 | **1 year 8 months**

• Senior Experience Strategist, Oct 2018 – Jun 2019 | **9 months**

Tasks

- Strategic and UX lead on both project and program clients by using research, synthesis, and data to inform the design and creation of digital products and services.

Achievements

- UX lead on Finansforbundet's digital transformation. Responsible for conceptualizing, designing, and optimizing +8 new digital solutions + leading a team of around 5 UX'ers and designers.
- UX lead on designing Club Matas' new customer-facing app from scratch + loyalty program. Club Matas is Denmark's largest loyalty club with 1.3 Mio members. Current iOS rating 4.6 rating / 32.800.

Apr 2018 – Oct 2018

6 months

www.firstborn.com

Firstborn is a design and innovation company who works with forward-looking companies to shape modern brands for a purpose-driven future. Named #7 best U.S. Design Studio.

Firstborn New York

Senior Experience Strategist

Tasks

- UX and strategy bridge by working across teams to create a more cohesive understanding of how the practice of strategic design should function
- Defining the direction of the strategy team going forward alongside the Strategy Director.

Achievements

- UX and concept lead on a new venture — the outcome was a skincare platform that creates a unique skin ID for users to make it easier to find new products
- Internal teaching of how to work with design thinking, work more agile in smaller teams and leverage hypothesis-driven design.

Jan 2014 – Jan 2018

4 years

www.noaignite.com

NoA Ignite designs and builds digital flagship experiences with the power to evoke emotions – the secret sauce to long term growth. NoA Ignite is on Fast Company's prestigious 'Most Innovative Companies' list in 2023!

NoA Ignite

• Senior Experience Strategist, Apr 2016 – Jan 2018 | **1 year 10 months**

• Digital Strategist, Jan 2014 – Apr 2016 | **2 years 4 months**

- Shaped early project visions by translating human insights into innovative business concepts and leading major new business projects, including slide deck creation and pitch presentations.
- Supported UX and design teams in concept development, workshops, and presentations.
- Led UX for Danske Bank's "Pocket Money" app (a debit card and money tool for children) and Varier's award-winning app promoting healthy sitting habits, showcased at DDA 2016 and IFA Berlin.

May 2013 – Jan 2014

9 months

www.monstarlab.com

Monstarlab (former Nodes) delivers expert engineering and stunningly designed digital solutions to unleash growth for businesses, customers, and society.

Monstarlab

Digital Advisor

- Collaborated closely with the CEO and Managing Partner to drive business development and took the lead in designing major new business pitches.
- Provided guidance to both new and existing clients on customer experience strategies and mobile app technology.

Oct 2011 – Apr 2013

1 year 7 months

www.thinkhouse.dk

Thinkhouse is a creative communication agency focusing on concept development of trade campaigns across all media platforms.

Thinkhouse

Creative Project Manager

- At Thinkhouse, I led diverse initiatives, from crafting digital campaign strategies and designing presentations to events for brands like Coca-Cola, Carlsberg, Tuborg, Mars and Snickers.
- My role was pivotal in integrating offline campaign events with digital and social media strategies, offering a holistic approach to creative communication.

Mar 2011 – Oct 2011

9 months

Riot Bernard sold stylish prescriptive glasses with a rebellious brand — online only. For every pair bought, we donated a pair to a person in need.

Riot Bernard Shanghai

Co-Founder

- As Co-founder of Riot Bernard, I spearheaded marketing for our rebellious brand, challenging Denmark's conventional optical market.
- We introduced stylish, online-only prescription glasses, with a mission to donate a pair for each sale.
- Notably, I helped establish key logistics and partnerships during a pivotal stay in Shanghai.

Oct 2010 – Jan 2011

4 months

www.wolffolins.com

Wolff Olins help create transformative brands that move businesses, people and the world forward.

Wolff Olins London

Intern

- At Wolff Olins, I developed creative tools to enhance client interactions, hosted co-creation workshops, and contributed to concept development and research for clients like American Express and Skype.

Higher education

Aug 2008 – Jun 2011

3 years

www.kaospilot.dk

The Kaospilots is a 3-year hybrid business and design school focusing on leadership and entrepreneurship.

The Kaospilots

Student

- The Kaospilots is a renowned three-year business and design school, recognized by BusinessWeek and FastCompany as a top global design school, focused on leadership, entrepreneurship, and preparing students for the dynamic startup economy.